BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Wednesday 21 Oct 2026, 07:50 Malaysia time (23:50 UTC, 20 Oct)

BTC ~ $82,950

CoinGecko: +1.2% 24h, -0.5% 7d

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral - range trade, mild downside skew	**Next 24h range:** $81,300 - $84,000 (base)	**Key floor:** $81,150, then $80,000	**Big event:** Daily expiry 4pm MYT today; weekly Fri 23 Oct; FOMC 29 Oct 2am MYT

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

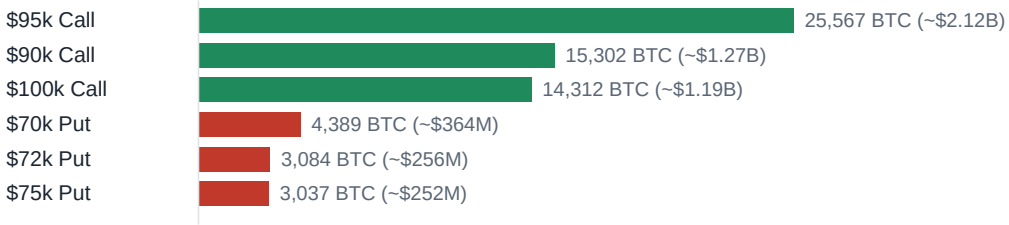
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily, today Wed 21 Oct at 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC). Daily expiries are usually small (a few hundred million USD) and rarely move price on their own.
- **Next weekly:** Fri 23 Oct 4:00pm MYT, about 14,759 BTC open (~$1.22B at $82,950) - modest. No public strike breakdown found this run.
- **The expiry that matters:** monthly Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm MYT, ~148,585 BTC (~$12.3B), call-heavy (P/C ~0.50), max pain $78,000-$79,000. Its strikes shape hedging flows all week.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
21 Oct daily (4pm)	Not available this run	n/a	Strike data could not be read; treat as small - not a price driver
23 Oct weekly (4pm)	Total OI only	14,759 BTC (~$1.22B)	Too small to pin price; watch for pin near round strikes $82k/$83k
30 Oct monthly - call	$95,000 Call	25,567 BTC (~$2.12B)	Far OTM; a magnet only if a rally runs; mostly lottery tickets
30 Oct monthly - put	$70,000 Put	4,389 BTC (~$364M)	Crash protection; puts are thin above $75k

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Wed 21 Oct, 4:00pm (daily)	n/a (small)	n/a	n/a	Not available this run
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.22B (14,759 BTC)	n/a	n/a	No breakdown published
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B (148,585 BTC)	0.50-0.52	$78,000-$79,000	Calls $95k 25.6k, $90k 15.3k, $100k 14.3k BTC; Puts $70k 4.4k, $72k 3.1k, $75k 3.0k BTC

Open interest by strike - 30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry (BTC contracts)



How options affect the market now

- **Today's daily and Friday's weekly are too small to move price** by themselves; expect at most a light pin near round strikes ($82k-$83k) into 4pm MYT.
- **Max pain ($78k-$79k) sits ~5% below spot.** Call holders lose most if BTC drifts lower into 30 Oct, so the pull into month-end is mildly downward, but it is a weak force more than a week out.
- **Call walls are far away** ($90k, $95k, $100k). Dealers are not forced to sell near the current price, so upside is capped more by spot sellers at $84k-$85k than by options.
- **Puts are thin above $75k.** Below $80k there is little dealer hedging support; a break could accelerate toward $78k as longs cut and new puts are bought.

- **Sentiment is mixed:** P/C ~0.50 on the monthly is bullish positioning, but 25-delta skew is negative (about -3.2 vol pts, puts pricier) and last Friday's smaller expiry printed P/C 1.37 - traders are hedging the downside short-term.
- **Volatility is cheap:** DVOL ~38 (implied daily move ~2.0%, about +/-$1,650) vs 14-day realized ~20%. Low vol tends to persist until a catalyst; FOMC (29 Oct MYT) is the obvious one.

Data note: the Deribit public API could not be read this run, so strike data comes from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 and 20 Oct, Au79, Blockhead). Treat sizes as 'largest seen'; USD values use $82,950.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC rebounded from ~$81,150 (24h low, Asia chip-stock sell-off on 20 Oct) to ~$82,950, with a brief spike to $83,250-$83,300.
- Since 12 Oct daily closes have stayed between ~$81,400 and ~$83,100; the weekly range is ~$79,700-$84,230.
- Price is back above the 50-day average (~$80,400-$81,600, by source); the 20-day line (~$83,240) and Ichimoku Kijun (~$83,460) are overhead.
- Still ~34% below the $126,080 all-time high; macro (oil above $100, 10y near 5.1%, hike risk) keeps rallies sold.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,000-$84,250	Range top and weekly high; daily close above opens $85,300 / $86,600
Resistance 1	$83,250-$83,460	24h high, 20-day average and Ichimoku Kijun
Pivot	$82,000-$82,600	Former ceiling; holding above keeps the bounce alive
Support	$81,150	24h low and lower edge of the daily Ichimoku cloud
Support 2	$79,700-$80,000	Round number, weekly low ($79,806 sweep on 19 Oct)
Deep risk	$78,000 then $75,000	Monthly max pain; Sept low $74,968 and the $75k put strike

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
BTC futures open interest	$67.1B (20 Oct)	Elevated, ~4% of market cap; leverage still present
Funding (8h)	+0.0079% (agg.); Deribit perp +0.0035%	Mildly positive, not crowded long
Liquidations (24h)	$241M total, BTC $49.4M (to 20 Oct)	Quiet vs the ~$850M cascade on 15 Oct
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$526.7M (19 Oct); -$10.3M partial (20 Oct)	IBIT +$665M was the biggest day in a year, partly rotation from FBTC/GBTC; last week -$228.6M
DVOL (30d implied vol)	~38.3 (12:00 UTC 20 Oct)	Low; implied daily move ~2.0%
25-delta skew (Nov)	about -3.2 vol pts	Puts priced above calls - hedging demand
Fear and Greed	44-49 (Fear / Neutral)	Down from 69 (Greed) on 4 Oct

4. News and macro

- **Fed:** blackout until 29 Oct. Rate is 3.75-4.00% after a Sept hike; markets price ~15% chance of another 25bp hike on 28 Oct (US) and above 80-90% by December. Sept CPI 3.7% vs 3.6% expected; PPI 6.3% y/y.
- **Oil and geopolitics:** Iran / Strait of Hormuz tension keeps Brent above $100 - an inflation and rate-hike risk that weighs on BTC.
- **ETFs:** BlackRock IBIT took $665M on 19 Oct (largest in a year); BlackRock is also moving to protect bitcoin investors after a rival fund fell 50%. Ether ETFs had a fourth straight outflow day.

- **Equities:** Asian chip stocks slid on 20 Oct (BTC dipped to $81,400) before US stocks recovered. Tesla, Meta and IBM report after the US close on Wed (early Thu MYT) - an AI/tech wobble could spill into crypto.
- **Industry:** Coinbase governance allegations (CoinDesk opinion, 20 Oct); Coinbase shares -7.6% on the week. JPMorgan projects ~10% annual BTC returns over the next decade.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Wed 21 Oct, 2:00pm	UK September CPI
Wed 21 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit daily BTC options expiry
Wed 21 Oct, 10:30pm	US EIA weekly oil inventories
Thu 22 Oct, ~4:00-5:00am	Tesla, Meta, IBM earnings (after US close)
Thu 22 Oct, 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly BTC options expiry (~$1.2B)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm / 10:00pm	US flash PMIs / UMich final sentiment
Sun 25 Oct	Brazil presidential runoff
Thu 29 Oct, 2:00am	FOMC decision (Chair Warsh press conference ~2:30am)
Thu 29 Oct, 8:30pm	US September PCE
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$12.2B, max pain $78k-$79k)
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US October payrolls
Tue 10 Nov, 9:30pm	US October CPI

5. Summary and prediction

BTC has bounced back to ~$82,950 inside its two-week $80k-$85k box. Options are not a near-term driver: today's daily and Friday's ~$1.2B weekly are small, while the $12.2B month-end book is call-heavy with walls far above at $90k-$100k and a max pain of $78k-$79k that leans slightly lower into 30 Oct. Implied vol (~38) is low, puts trade at a premium, funding is neutral and ETF demand is patchy, so the market is waiting for macro (oil, tech earnings, FOMC). Expect chop between $81.3k and $84k unless one edge breaks. **24h call: range-bound $81,300-$84,000, slight downside lean; a daily close above $84,250 or below $81,150 decides the next leg.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base - range	55%	$81,300 - $84,000	No macro shock; pin near $82k-$83k into 4pm expiry; ETF flows mixed
Bullish breakout	20%	$84,000 - $86,600	Hourly/daily close above $84,250 with spot ETF inflows and calm oil; strong tech earnings
Bearish break	25%	$78,000 - $81,150	Loss of $81,150, oil spike or tech sell-off; downside accelerates below $80k toward max pain

- **Upside signal:** 4h/daily close above $84,250 with rising spot volume and positive ETF flow - targets $85,300 then $86,600.
- **Downside signal:** break of $81,150 and then $80,000 with funding turning negative - opens $78,000 (max pain).
- Next report: 3:50pm MYT (Wed 21 Oct)

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